policy aimed at popular sectors and carried out either by business groups or associations dependent upon business financing. A varying number of groups become state auxiliaries in the execution of practices aimed at lessening the impact of growing inequalities. Protagonists of a new political modality of social and public resource management, they meanwhile maintain the target group distant from the development of national policy. This is the label of origin of countless public–private partnerships.

Their international counterpart is also significant: sub-national segmentation mirrors a similar specialisation on the international scene also regarded as 'apolitical'. As can be seen, adjustments in the way capitalist states operate merit a deeper study than permitted by the space of this chapter. It is worthwhile mentioning another growing aspect of state internationalisation, which does not take away from its importance or that of the local bourgeoisie. The official international institutions originating at Bretton Woods have undergone adjustments to the extent that peripheral country bourgeoisies do not just believe capital-imperialist prescriptions and values but train their intellectuals in the new international management institutes (whose model has been the dissemination of the Masters in Business Administration – MBAs); these peripheral country intellectuals are integrated into extensive economic and political policy-formulating networks (think tanks and NGOs) and, no less important, they propagate this model domestically (Dreifuss 1986). This is without speaking about the co-participation in national and international economic enterprises of businesses from subordinate capital-imperialist countries and their establishment of local offices attached to international agencies (such as the World Bank or IMF) directly coupled with public institutions.

Subaltern yet domestically strong bourgeoisies are shaped by their own capitalist interests in value appropriation and are unequally interlocked with the capitalist-imperialist enterprise, which they embrace. They are prepared to try new economic formats on a large scale in their countries presently under 'democratic' guise. In counterpart they bring to international entities – and to the class struggles in other countries – an experience weighed down by constantly updated truculence from their historical domination. Furthermore, this owes nothing to some genetic flaw but started with the very colonisation process under which many BRICS members were constituted and of which they are the direct heirs. One cannot forget that dominant groups from the central countries decisively intervened in the use of violence, as Agamben (2004) and Arantes (2007) recalled.

The sixth and last characteristic of capital-imperialism is the dissemination